

ASHISH POUDEL

Development Finance Professional · Policy Researcher

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[LinkedIn](#) · [SSRN](#) · [GitHub](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Institutional governance of climate transition, Comparative financial sector policy in South Asia, Sustainable finance regulation and green taxonomies, Macroeconomic policy in developing economies

EDUCATION

Master of Business Studies (Finance)

Nepal Commerce Campus, Minbhawan, Tribhuvan University · 2024

Thesis: Impact of Macroeconomic Variables on the Stock Market Index, A Vector Error Correction Model Approach. Extended and published as an SSRN working paper (2026).

Bachelor of Business Administration (Banking and Finance)

Prithivi Narayan Campus, Tribhuvan University · 2017

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

Poudel, A. (2026). Climate Action through Financial Inclusion: The Role of DCGF in Fostering Eco-Friendly Enterprises. *SSRN Working Paper*, under peer review. [\[link\]](#)

Poudel, A., & Sapkota, S. (2026). Macroeconomic Determinants of the Nepal Stock Exchange Index: A VECM Approach. *SSRN Working Paper*, under peer review. [\[link\]](#)

Poudel, A. (2026). How India's Monetary Policy Shapes Nepal's Economy: Nepal Needs Greater Monetary Flexibility. *South Asia Monitor*, May 2026. [\[link\]](#)

Poudel, A. (2025). Cybersecurity and Deposit Guarantee in Nepal's Digital Era. *Sanjibani, DCGF Annual Publication*. [\[link\]](#)

APPLIED RESEARCH

Climate Vulnerability and Economic Resilience: A Country Clustering Analysis

[Repository](#) · [Interactive dashboard](#)

Machine learning analysis clustering countries by climate vulnerability and economic readiness, with a focus on South Asia. Built in Python using K-Means clustering, principal component analysis, and ensemble regression models, deployed as an interactive dashboard.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Chair, South Asia Regional Chapter, SME Finance Forum (IFC, World Bank Group)

June 2026, Present

One of seven regional Co-Chairs shaping the chapter's priorities on SME finance, credit guarantees, and gender-inclusive finance across six South Asian countries, in collaboration with IFC South Asia and the World Bank Gender Innovation Lab.

**Assistant Officer, Credit Guarantee Department, Deposit and Credit Guarantee Fund,
Government of Nepal**

March 2025, Present

Design and monitor credit guarantee schemes for small enterprises and smallholder farmers. Contribute to the World Bank-supported Sustainable and Inclusive Finance Project and a UNDP-partnered agricultural guarantee scheme. Conduct policy and regulatory analysis, coordinating with Nepal Rastra Bank and the Ministry of Finance.

Recovery Audit Specialist, Flexible Technology Solutions

January 2019, March 2024

Led audit teams across Nepal and India investigating financial discrepancies in global e-commerce supply chains. Served as subject matter expert and trainer.

SKILLS

Quantitative methods, Time-series econometrics (VECM, cointegration, Granger causality), machine learning, statistical modelling. EViews, SPSS, Python (pandas, scikit-learn, Plotly).

Research and policy, Policy analysis, regulatory review, analytical writing for institutional and public audiences.

Languages, English (PTE Academic: 82/90, C1), Nepali (native).

CIVIL SOCIETY

Vice President, Pragya Youth Forum, Family Planning Association of Nepal, Kaski (2015 to 2017).
President, PNC BBA SPHERE Student Society (2014 to 2015).